

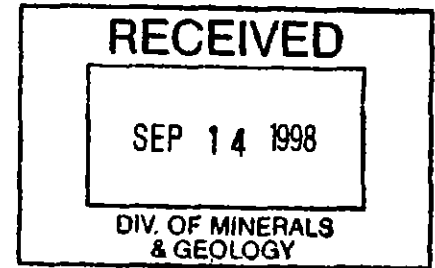


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Milled
To Coal

**St. Vrain Valley
Community Watchdogs**
neighbors united for clean air

P.O. Box 82/ Hygiene/ CO 80533-0082



To: Watchdogs and Interested Parties

From: Steering Committee

Re: Update

On August 18, 1998, fourteen Watchdogs met with 2 officials from Southdown Lyons and 3 officials from the corporate headquarters in Houston. Ms. Gabi Hoefler, Boulder County Health Department, chaired the meeting.

Two encouraging items were accomplished during the meeting: (1) lines of communication were re-established; (2) John Lohr, plant manager said that he would prepare a layman's guide to the permit application. **This guide is enclosed for your examination.** A second meeting is scheduled for 6 October.

Watchdog's position:

(1) We Need Air Quality Monitoring Stations:

The lungs' constant interaction with the environment--the air we breathe--makes the impact of that environment inescapable. How well, or how poorly, our lungs perform depends directly on the state of the air around us.

Lung Disease Data 1997 American Lung Association p. 22.

The Longmont Station (3rd and Kimbark) is approximately 10 miles from Southdown, and according to an official at the Boulder County Health Department, it is more than likely that fugitive dust and PM 10 particulates will filter out before reaching the monitor station in Longmont or Boulder City. The Watchdogs believe that these stations are not sufficiently and adequately located to accurately determine the health risk to portions of the community living closer to fugitive dust sources including PM 10.

The American Lung Association emphasized in a report, The Perils of Particulates,

The danger line has now been drawn at the PM 10 level, since these particules are still small enough to be drawn deep into the tracheo-bronchial region, the windpipe and the air passages within the lungs. These particles are classified as inhalable. Excessive PM 10 levels are

deemed to place four groups at special risk: pre-adolescents (those aged 13 years or less), persons 65 years and older, asthma patients, and those with COPD (chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, including emphysema and chronic bronchitis.) p. 24.

In May of 1997, The American Lung Association estimated the prevalence and incidence of lung disease for Boulder County: Population 249,623

Lung cancer:	141
Emphysema:	1,760
Chronic Bronchitis:	13,441
Adult Asthma:	9,405
Pediatric Asthma	4,577

We need to take these estimates seriously as they affect the health of our families and neighbors. **The Watchdogs will continue to request that the regulatory agency install an air quality monitor station in this community.**

(2) Characterization of Dust/Particulates: We really don't know what it contains.

Look again at our reality in the photograph of episodic fugitive dust plumes from a site specific source. These undefined, uncharacterized particulates and dust pose an intolerable risk to the health and well-being of the residents of this community. **The Watchdogs will continue to request the regulatory agency to conduct a chemical characterization of these substances that are being discharged into our environment.**

(3) A Public Hearing is Appropriate: We have requested a public hearing so that (A) citizens may voice their concerns and opinions regarding Southdown's permit application; (B) regulators may address these concerns.

(4) New Development: Once again, Senator Ben Nighthorse Campbell has responded to our distress call and asked the EPA to make an inquiry into this situation. The EPA's preliminary response is quite encouraging. **Copy enclosed.**

(5) See attached announcement -- Watchdogs' Web Site.

(6) See attached announcement--Community Advocacy